was afraid of the new and frightening city that Boston had suddenly become when I discovered Bill would not be there.

On returning home, I found that the May 1949 Astounding had come, with "Mother Earth" 1 in it, but that was scarcely compensation.

Sunday, May 8, 1949, was Mother's Day. It seemed inappropriate that I should wake at 5:00 a.m. with an acute and continuous abdominal cramp. I could not lie down or sit or stand. I could only walk back and forth, doubled up and groaning.

After twenty minutes of this, we were on the point of calling a doctor, since both Gertrude and I were suspecting acute appendicitis, when the pain started easing up, then went away. It left me with a feeling of relief and, almost, euphoria, for there is nothing like the absence of pain, after pain.

1 See The Early Asimov.

It did not recur, and so we did not take up the matter with a doctor. Gertrude and I both still lived with the notion that one didn't see a doctor if one didn't have to.

It was too bad. Had I known what was wrong, I might have been spared future discomfort.

3

On May 10, I gave my first lecture for a general audience. It was for Pauline Bloom, of the old Brooklyn Authors Club. She had a writing class and wanted me to talk on science fiction and fantasy. The audience consisted of about thirty people, mostly middle-aged women, and I doubt that any of them knew anything at all about science fiction or fantasy. My diary states, "I did very nicely" but gives no details and I remember nothing about it.

But it was another quiet beginning for a facet of my life.

4

On May 12, I went to Boston for a third time and, for the first time, Gertrude accompanied me. We tried to find living quarters, but returned on the fifteenth, having spent $76 and gained nothing.

But then, on May 17, we received a letter from Lemon, who told us that a